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Christine Wouters

Waterschap De Dommel

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Beste lezer,

Met deze motivatiebrief wil ik graag solliciteren naar de positie van Adviseur Waterkwaliteit bij Waterschap De Dommel. De werkzaamheden en doelstellingen van deze functie spreken mij bijzonder aan. Hoewel ik inmiddels bijna twee jaar in Nederland woon, ben ik de taal nog aan het leren en druk ik mijzelf makkelijker uit in het Engels:

My interest in water quality has shaped both my academic and professional development. Growing up near the Alpine lakes sparked a lasting fascination about water and its importance to both people and the environment. Throughout my studies, I have sought opportunities to deepen my understanding of water and water quality management and contribute to addressing current environmental challenges. After completing my Bachelor's degree in Germany, I spent a semester in Vienna as part of the Erasmus programme, where I first became aware of the Netherlands' internationally renowned approach to water management. Inspired by this, I chose to pursue a Master's degree in Water Science and Management at Utrecht University, where I am currently completing my thesis. Having lived in the Netherlands for the past two years, I am eager to continue my career here.

During my Bachelor's thesis, I completed a three-month internship at a water treatment plant in Serbia, where I gained practical insight into drinking water treatment and the importance of maintaining high water quality standards. With the assistance of my colleagues at the plant, I learned to apply theoretical knowledge in practice, while also developing my communication and teamwork skills. The experience, even if very stressful at times, taught me to remain calm under pressure and to adapt quickly to challenging scenarios. I also learned how to interpret water quality data on sight, which still helps me to better understand the data I am working with today. During my Master's, I specialised further in water quality through my thesis on PFAS, while also gaining experience with the Water Framework Directive, EU legislation, and Dutch water regulations. I particularly enjoy analysing scientific information and translating technical knowledge into practical recommendations. My Master's thesis focuses on the use of innovative polymer materials to remove PFAS from water, combining laboratory experimentation with the evaluation of technologies that could contribute to future water treatment. My research work in this emerging field has strengthened my analytical skills, my problem-solving abilities and my resilience in dealing with unexpected challenges. The opportunity to combine scientific analysis, policy, and practical water management in this advisory role is therefore especially appealing to me.

What particularly attracts me to the position at Waterschap De Dommel is the opportunity to contribute to improving water quality across different environments while working with colleagues from different disciplines. I am especially motivated by the opportunity to help protect valuable natural areas such as the Kampina, where good water quality is essential for maintaining unique ecosystems. I am eager to continue developing my expertise in water quality, contribute to innovative projects, and help translate scientific knowledge into practical solutions that improve water and living quality in the region.

Thank you for considering my application.

Kind regards,

Immanuel Dietrich